Forms

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In 2018, I naively joined a class, CLST 267, Scientific and Medical Terminology at Loyola, thinking it would be a class on, well… medical terminology. Perhaps we would learn words in their medical context, like the clinical definition of depression, or technical words like nephrolithiasis. Instead, it was a course listed in the classics and taught by one Kirk Shellko. Dr. Shellko would lecture with a slight grin, almost bemused, as he would explain the worldview of Democritus and Hippocrates. As if a stipulative fiat is the setup for a good joke. The class was on how scientific and medical thought became canonized through Greek thought into its modern formulation, a history and philosophy course, not a class on kidney failiure and psychomodulatory drugs. At first, I was disappointed, but then I was intrigued.

Over the years, I've come to greater appreciate the value of such learning. It was during CLST 267 that I first synthesized exactly the philosophy underlying the science I was practicing in the lab and was exposed to Thomas Kuhn's approach to scientific paradigm and revolution. Even more beautiful was when I was exposed to how these same ideas was filtered through the lens of Muslim Philosophers, such as Avicenna and Ghazali. Again and again, I find myself thinking about many of these fundamental concepts in philosophy and how they inform and are informed. Currently, while reviewing *Al-ʿAqīdah At-Taḥāwī*, I spuriously felt I wanted to take time to dictate some of these thoughts, from condensing my sparse notes in a historical overview to my current synthesis and reflections to a review based on ʿaqīdah.

I pray Allah grants me tawfīq to finish these notes with completeness and rigor and find great benefit in the process of compilation as well as in review.